

# TUGRUL GUNER

AI Engineering Leader | Portfolio Strategy | Hands-on Architecture

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## PROFILE

AI engineering leader and hands-on architect who builds high-performing teams and scalable, robust backend, AI, and agentic systems. Lead two cross-functional pods across a portfolio of more than six products, combining product direction and stakeholder leadership with architecture and production delivery. Operate well under pressure and make difficult tradeoffs without lowering engineering standards.

## EXPERIENCE

### AI Engineering Manager | CDAI

Toronto, ON | Jan 2026 - Present

- Lead two separate cross-functional pods of five and seven people across a portfolio of more than six products, with responsibility for technical direction, cross-team alignment, and delivery.
- In under six months, led one pod to a 2.5x increase in delivery velocity and helped the team launch three products. That delivery improvement led to responsibility for the second, separate pod.
- Helped deliver a recommendation system that improved menu-item attachment rate by 4x.
- Remain hands-on: prototype ideas, make architectural changes, deliver production work, and build shared platforms that reduce redundancy and improve scalability.
- Build high-performing teams around ownership and engineering standards; started the AI & Science channel and co-host the company-wide AI Center of Excellence meeting.

### Technical Manager, AI Architect | Haptiq

Toronto, ON | May 2025 - Jan 2026

- Built Haptiq's AI team and first AI infrastructure from the ground up; recruited and led seven people across ML engineering, MLOps, and backend development.
- Led technical delivery and client conversations for the company's first AI product, helping sell AI solutions to companies and contributing to more than \$2M in new revenue.
- Worked with clients and executives on product direction, architecture, delivery plans, risk assessments, and performance reporting.
- Established ownership, knowledge-sharing, reviews, documentation, release management, and sprint planning for reliable delivery.

### Senior Tech Lead | Quotograph.io

Waterloo, Ontario, Canada (Remote) | Jul 2025 - Present

### Chief Technology Officer | Quotograph.io

Waterloo, Ontario, Canada (Remote) | Jan 2024 - Jul 2025

### Lead MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Dec 2024 - May 2025

- Architected scalable AI and backend systems aligned with business goals and integrated Ray with Kubernetes.
- Led cross-functional delivery, mentoring, cost optimization, availability, and fault-tolerance work.

### Senior MLOps Engineer | Arteria AI

Toronto, ON | Sep 2022 - Dec 2024

- Automated backend systems for model integration and scaling, and built user-friendly APIs for rapid experimentation and deployment.
- Reduced Kubernetes infrastructure costs by 60% with KServe and improved model performance 10x with quantization and ONNX.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and Databricks to streamline the machine-learning lifecycle.

## TECHNICAL RANGE

**Languages:** Python, SQL, Bash, Git | **ML:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, DSPy, vLLM

**Agents:** Hermes Agent, Superpowers, Deep Agents, Pydantic AI, LangGraph, MCP/FastMCP | **MLOps:** KServe, MLflow, Ray Serve, LitServe

**Platforms:** AWS, Azure, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Databricks, GitHub Actions | **Systems:** FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, Qdrant, MongoDB, Redis, RabbitMQ

## EDUCATION & RESEARCH

**Postdoctoral Fellow**, University of Ottawa, 2021–2022 — deep learning for quantum optics and beam shaping

**Postdoctoral Fellow**, Institut national de la recherche scientifique (INRS), 2018–2021 — ultrafast transmission electron microscopy and measurement algorithms

**MBA**, Quantic School of Business and Technology, 2025 | **Ph.D., Materials Science and Engineering**, Izmir Institute of Technology, 2018  
30 journal publications, one patent, 1,023 Google Scholar citations, h-index 19, i10-index 21 (September 2026).

## OPEN SOURCE & WRITING

Created **ModePot**, an open-source family focused on simpler APIs, modern runtimes, performance, and bounded agent-owned decisions. Contribute to **Hermes Agent** and **Superpowers**. Write **Passionately Curious** and publish essays on Medium.